# The SimCo Bulletin

*“Better then a dumpster, yet worse then the official!” - The publisher*



## New PA Quests, Worth It? by Kinetic Couture

The world of Sim Companies is always changing. The recent changes to Personal Assistant (PA) quests, including the introduction of our new assistant, Paige, have certainly created some buzz in the boardroom. While some executives celebrate the updates, others are worried about their finances. Here’s what the latest PA quests offer.

The days of just clicking through PA prompts are gone. The new, high-stakes quests come with strict requirements before they can even start. Your company needs to meet certain "Time Played" metrics, have Level 15 Executive qualifications, and, most importantly, have enough cash to cover possible losses—a $50,000 buffer.

When a quest appears, your choices will determine the outcome. The community has categorized these results. The best choices lead to "purple" outcomes (the ideal result). Risky or wrong choices usually lead to "blue" outcomes, which are not as good or have negative effects.

There is plenty to appreciate about these updates. Achieving a favorable outcome can provide a cash boost or production bonuses. Classic events, such as isolating a physics lab for the legendary "sausage quest" to earn $150,000, are exciting breaks from the routine of the supply chain. Additionally, these quests require CEOs to think critically about how a single event affects production and retail overall. This makes the simulation feel lively, and it’s been amazing to see the community come together to figure out the best choices.

However, the price for a wrong choice can be high—sometimes painfully so. Losing $50,000 from a single bad decision can be a huge setback, especially when you are in the middle of growing. If you are transforming an industrial operation into a fashion retail brand like Kinetic Couture, while struggling to keep sneakers and leather shoes in stock, a sudden $50,000 penalty from a PA event isn't just irritating; it can derail your expansion. For companies without large cash reserves, these high-level quests can feel more like traps than opportunities.

In the end, the updated PA quests bring much-needed unpredictability to Sim Companies. The game relies on taking calculated risks, and these events deliver just that. Still, the requirements seem a bit steep. Needing a $50,000 buffer just to participate can exclude mid-level companies that reinvest every dollar they make. My advice? The rewards are definitely worth it, but don't take unnecessary risks. Keep an eye on your executive levels, maintain your cash buffer, and always check the community guides before trusting Paige with significant company decisions.

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## How Dairy May Be The Best Industry By Carey Dairy Inc.

There are many industries to get involved in within the SimCompanies universe: mining, oil refining, construction, aerospace, automobiles, restaurants, research—the list goes on. When new players sign up and join, they are thrown into the agriculture sector. Their first question is inevitably, "What do I do?", usually followed by an onslaught of beginner guide links. Their second question is typically something along the lines of, "What's the best industry to get into?" It is safe to say there is a strong implication that they mean, "I don't want to be a farmer; I want something fancier."

I asked several random companies what their first industry was after the initial farming introduction. General mining, battery-focused mining, fashion (via making cotton on existing farms), cement manufacturing, construction materials in a hybrid production/retail setup, electronics, and automotive were some of the answers I received.

The point is, while some people expand on their initial farms and grocery stores, players generally seem in a hurry to leave the fields behind for something more robust. Even I did it. I started SimCompanies on Halloween of last year. Within a week, I was done with crops and was using my farms to produce wood to turn into planks. I then started making and retailing underwear myself (before the retail fix), and later dabbled in oil refining.

But a couple of months later, the call of the fields beckoned me back. By December, I scrapped my entire map and transitioned into fully self-contained, vertically integrated dairy farming. I eventually learned from helpful community members that vertical integration can be limiting if taken too far—but that's an article for another time—and reeled it in. Now, I have just a couple of ranches and a bunch of food processing plants. Milk, butter, and cheese: full-spectrum dairy production.

The more I commit to the dairy game, the more I realize how truly versatile it is. Butter and cheese share the same input (milk), albeit in different amounts. They are also both made in food processing plants. While both products are used further down production chains to make other foods, both can be used as-is in restaurants, and cheese can be sold directly in grocery stores. By simply adjusting the amount of milk allocated, you can swap production between cheese and butter without any additional setup or changes.

If you don't have daily buyers and sell directly on the exchange, you can adjust production based on demand. Are butter prices falling, leaving your stock buried on the exchange? Switch some plants over to cheese production and target that market instead. Perhaps a daily buyer messages you asking for more cheese than you currently supply. If you have a daily excess of butter without a committed buyer, you can easily convert a plant or two over to cheese production, allowing you to maintain and grow that client relationship.

I interviewed a few other dairy producers as well. Canadian Mozzarella Cheese Co. was honored to discuss their operation. It turns out that besides cheese production, they also produce butter to lower the cost of dough for future pizza-making, which will utilize their own stringy cheese. Their other cheese is produced via robot assistance and sold via contract to other companies for further refining and grocery retail.

DIMEXGAMER Unhealthy Foods chose the dairy industry because they "made money and there was a demand for it." They simply "did what worked." Unlike CMC Co., DIMEXGAMER strictly produces butter and sells mainly through the exchange.

As with most resources, dairy industry prices were hit substantially by the recession spanning late April and early May. When asked about the current status of the butter market—given that the price of quality-four butter fell 18% over the past month—Wyoming Management said, “It is still strong and a good product to keep working with.” A look at Wyoming Management’s map reveals a layout divided between food processing plants and quarries. They entered the dairy industry because a friend was in need. At the time, they noticed the market fluctuated and that they could make good money with limestone. Dealing in two totally different markets gives Wyoming Management the flexibility needed to navigate a down market.

I was also able to have a brief chat with The Gentlemen, the leading milk producer, who turned out 22.39 million units in April 2026. They tried a few different ventures over the years before settling on milk—mainly due to “brilliant feed suppliers.” They sell primarily through contracts rather than the exchange, even at the cost of better market prices. To them, solid relationships are more important than profit margins.

In a world full of decisions between the vastness of aerospace, the allure of gold, or the whir of machinery, the dairy industry serves as the quiet, reliable pulse that keeps the entire economy fed. It proves that while flashier trends fly high, real money is made on solid ground.

If you enjoyed this article, please give it a like or feel free to send me a message. If this article is a hit, I am inclined to turn it into a series where I profile a different industry each time, diving deep with company owners to get the real, raw details behind decision-making across the SimCompanies economy.

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# Economic Phases and Their Impact by Appalachian State University

One of the most important mechanics affecting the economy is the current economic phase. These phases influence both production costs and retail selling prices, which means understanding them can make a major difference in profitability and long-term planning. The three economic phases are recession, normal, and boom, and the economy may shift between them every Friday at 11:00 AM.

During a recession, production costs are lower, which can help manufacturers produce goods more cheaply. However, the downside is that retail selling prices also decrease, making it harder to maintain strong profit margins. In a normal economy, things are more balanced, with standard production costs and more stable selling prices. During a boom, businesses face higher production costs, but they also gain the ability to sell products at significantly higher retail prices.

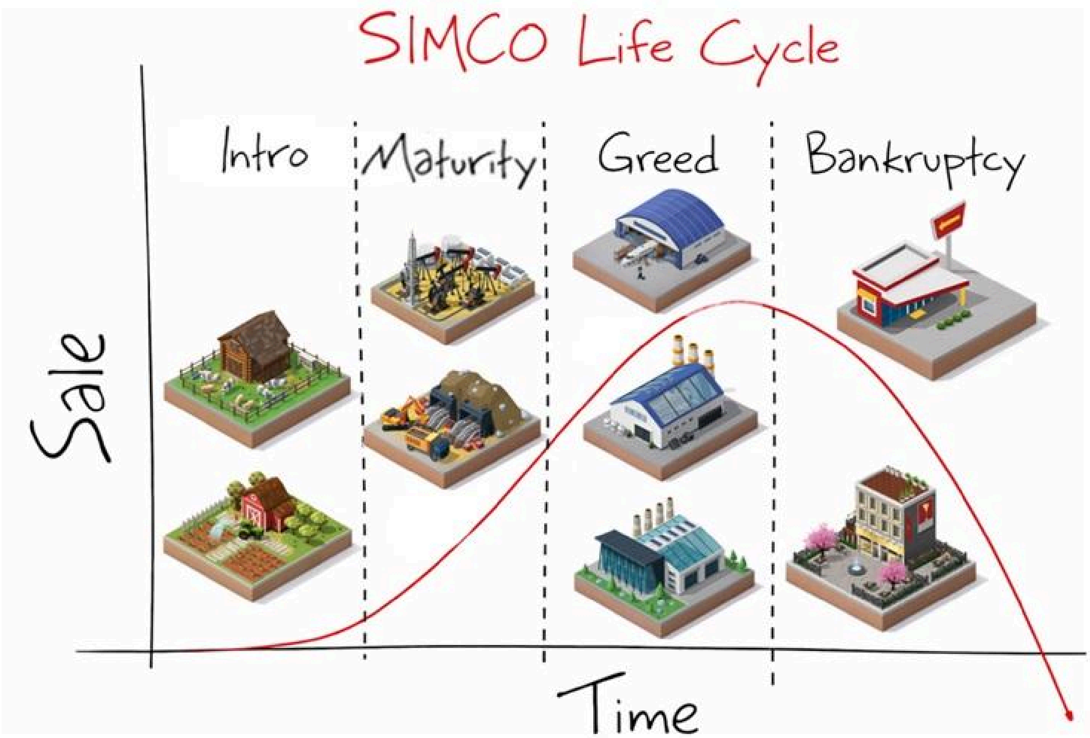
Because these phases can change every Friday at 11:00 AM, planning ahead becomes extremely important. Companies may choose to stockpile products during cheaper production periods or wait to retail goods until economic conditions improve. Timing can play a huge role in maximizing profits.

That said, I personally feel like the market doesn't always react to these economic phase changes as strongly or as quickly as expected. Even though we recently moved out of a recession during the week of May 22 through May 29, it still feels like we're partially stuck in recession conditions. Prices for many items do not seem to be increasing at the rate I would expect after entering a stronger economic phase.

Part of this could be because markets take time to adjust. Players may still be pricing cautiously after the recession, excess inventory may still exist, or buyers may not yet be willing to pay higher prices immediately after the phase change. Even if the official economy status changes, player behavior and supply levels can delay the market's response. Another possibility is that the effects of an economic phase change vary significantly between industries and products. Some goods may experience immediate price increases when conditions improve, while others remain largely unchanged because supply is still abundant or demand remains weak. This can make the economy feel uneven, where certain sectors appear to be benefiting from a normal or boom phase while others continue to behave as if recession conditions are still in place.

Overall, the economic phase system adds an interesting strategic layer to the game. However, it also highlights how market psychology, supply and demand, and player behavior can sometimes matter just as much as the official economic conditions themselves. As a result, players may need to look beyond the economic phase indicator and pay close attention to the specific markets in which they operate.

## MeeM by National Reserves




# Quotes

### "Imma just delete this app ig" - Plan 99

### "Give every day the chance to become the most beautiful day of your life." - Mark Twain

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